

Chapter 5: The Moment Between Us

Luna didn't realize when things started changing.

Maybe it was the way she stopped hesitating before walking through the door.

Or the way her eyes searched for him first... every single time.

Or maybe—

It was the way her heart felt calmer the moment she saw him.

"Kyros!"

She ran toward him, a small smile already forming on her lips.

He turned, and this time—

He smiled first.

"You're getting faster," he said softly.

"Or maybe you're getting easier to find," she replied.

He chuckled.

And just like that—

Everything felt light again.

They walked together like always.

But something was different today.

Closer. Warmer.

Their shoulders brushed more often.

Their hands almost touched... more than once.

And every time it happened—

Neither of them pulled away immediately.

"Can I ask you something?" Luna said suddenly.

"You always do," Kyros replied.

She rolled her eyes slightly. "Serious ah."

"I'm listening."

She slowed her steps.

"Why do you feel... important to me?"

He didn't answer immediately.

That made her more nervous.

"I mean... I don't even know you properly," she continued.

"But when I'm not here, I keep thinking about you. Too much."

Kyros stopped walking. So did she.

"Maybe," he said quietly, "some people aren't meant to feel like strangers."

"That's not an answer."

"It's the only one I have."

A silence fell. Not awkward. But heavy.

"Luna..."

"Hm?"

"What do you feel when you're here?"

"Peace."

"And when I'm with you... I feel like I don't have to pretend anything."

"That's rare."

"I know."

The wind moved gently around them.

Kyros reached out and tucked her hair behind her ear.

"Kyros..."

"Yeah?"

"I think... I'm starting to like you."

"I was wondering when you'd say that."

"You... have?"

"For a while now."

"Then why didn't you say anything?"

"Because I didn't want to rush you."

"Idiot..." she muttered, smiling.

"Say it properly."

"What?"

"What you feel. I want to hear it."

"Luna... I like you. Not just a little.

I think about you even when you're not here.

I wait for you.

And when you leave... everything feels empty."

"Then don't stop there."

"Will you stay with me?"

"I already am."

They held hands.

"Then say it."

"I like you too."

"That's it?"

"What more do you want?"

"Something I can believe in when you're not here."

"...I love you."

"I love you too."

"This feels scary."

"It is. But it's worth it."

Far away, the golden light began to appear again.

But this time—they didn't look at it.

Because right now—

Nothing else mattered.

Only this moment.

Only them.